Aisling centre

Hope Healing Growth

Annual Report

2017-2018

www.theaislingcentre.com


Annual car wash creates a splash for Aisling Centre

Watch Commander John McGuigan (NIFRS Irvinestown) ... for £1,310.


Erne Travel raises money for Aisling Centre

Lisa McNulty, (second right), manager of Erne Travel, is pictured handing over a cheque to Bridie Sweeney, (second left), Aisling Centre. Also included are from left, Olivia Irwin, Tracey Donaldson and Charlene Coffey, Erne Travel. Whilst hosting an Erne Travel Open Day Event recently, staff took the opportunity to hold a Coffee Morning in support of The Aisling Centre in Enniskillen. The amount raised was £256. Thanks have been extended to everyone who contributed and donated.

"Excellent service, dread to think where I would be without this service; although my situation is ongoing my therapist has given me some methods to face any challenges or problems that lie ahead."











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Aisling centre
Hope Healing Growth

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Chairperson's Foreword



I am delighted to present to you this our 27th Annual Report. Over the past year Aisling has continued to work to serve the community through its core services of counselling, psychotherapy and play therapy, endeavoring to give hope, to heal, and to foster the growth of the individual as per its mission statement. Attendance at counselling is not an easy journey but it can bring life-changing results, perhaps best expressed in the words of a client.

"I would advise anyone that has troubles that the counselling is hard but it works, excellent in the end and light at the end, thank you."

We could not do this very valuable work without the support of our core funders and we are very thankful to them for their on-going support (see page 35 for details). This year we were also fortunate to have become one of the NI beneficiaries of the St. John of God Foundation. When they closed their Northern Ireland facility they felt that money raised here should go towards helping the people of Northern Ireland. Aisling Centre was identified as a one of a number of worthy charities whose aims and objectives were consistent with their ethos. We subsequently met with their Director and were delighted to become recipients of much needed funds and we look forward to working with them in the year ahead.

However the continually growing demand for services remains a constant challenge in straitened economic times and we are constantly trying to raise additional funds to meet the growing need - vital if we to be able to keep our waiting list to the minimum and to allow us to respond quickly to people who are in crisis. Our fund-raising sub-committee supported by the local community continues to be exceptional in their efforts with all monies raised going directly towards our core work of counselling.

"The staff are great and very welcoming and my therapist was brilliant and has helped me no end. I would hope that more funding would be made available to such an invaluable service in the hope that waiting times could be reduced."

We believe in having strong administrative and governance systems in place to support our work so that we are transparent and accountable to our clients, supporters and the wider local community. This year we have undertaken a number of consultations and joint workshops with staff and volunteers and updated our strategic plan for the next 3-years. We have also undertaken training in the Theory of Change and reviewed our systems in line with GDPR (data protection) updates.

As the year draws to a close I would like to thank all those who have supported us financially, and also those who have worked tirelessly for the 'cause' of Aisling, be they Directors, staff or 'friends' of Aisling and of course I could not let the year pass without mentioning Barry and Declan and all in the Westend Coffee Shop as they prepare to celebrate their 20th anniversary. I would like to record our sincere thanks to them for all their support and friendship over the past two decades.

Thank you one and all. Without you we would not be here in our turn, supporting the wider community.

Ann

Strategic Plan 2017 - 2020

Vision / Dream

Positive Mental Health and Emotional Well-Being for All.

Mission

To provide opportunities for hope, healing and growth in a welcoming and supportive environment.

Commitment

Striving to meet Professional and Ethical Service Standards.

Adopting an evidence-based approach within a robust outcome measurement framework.

Principles / Values

Confidential, Respectful, Empathic, Supportive, Non-judgemental and Inclusive of All.

Working collaboratively with others to achieve shared objectives.

Sensitivity to Current & Emerging Needs.

Strategic Priorities

- To promote positive mental health and emotional well-being for adults, young people and children in Co Fermanagh and the surrounding area through the provision of an accessible and professional counselling, psychotherapy and play therapy service.
- To provide a range of additional activities that will enhance and complement the therapeutic work of the Centre and give additional support to clients.
- To ensure that the Aisling Centre is an effective, accountable, transparent organisation that meets the requirements of all stakeholders.

Centre Co-ordinator's' Report



As I reflect back on the work of the year I am always struck by the courage of the growing numbers of people who use our services; people of all ages with increasingly complex and urgent needs; the most important people in our charity. We have endeavoured to reflect their experiences throughout this report using composite and anonymised experiences of counselling and client quotes. These tell the story of the Aisling Centre much better than anything I could write.

I also feel a sense of frustration because, the on-going challenge remains the same year-on-year as we strive to respond to a growing demand for services that is always greater than the resources available. Despite this we continue to offer a service that makes a positive difference in people's lives, enabling them to find their voice and feel that they are heard, often for the first time.

I would like to second the Chairperson's words of thanks to all our funders and supporters who have enabled our work to continue. As demand for services grow, we become increasingly more dependent on the generosity of donors and we have to work harder to raise the funds needed so, a special word of thanks goes to our fundraising sub-committee, community fund-raisers and the many friends of the Aisling Centre. We benefit greatly from your support and without you it would not be possible for us to achieve so much.

No report on the work of the Aisling Centre would be complete without mention of the many wonderful organisations who work out of the Centre; they contribute so much, not only in the professionalism of their services but also in helping to promote the atmosphere of welcome, safety and healing that is synonymous with the Aisling Centre.

As we move forward into a New Year we will re-double our efforts to secure funds and donations to meet the growing demand for counselling. We also look forward to extending our team of Mindfulness Meditation Teachers and, we hope to secure funds do some much needed building maintenance.

As always this work will be undertaken by a team of enthusiastic and dedicated staff and volunteers supported by a steadfast and committed Board of Directors; my sincere thanks and gratitude to you all for your on-going hard work and support and I look forward to another successful year as we work together to realise our dream of positive mental health and emotional well-being for all.

Bridie

Clinical Co-ordinator's Report



The time of the annual report is a period when we are obliged to take a step back from the day to day activity in order to look at the entirety of the work undertaken over the previous twelve months. Part of the task of reporting is rightly about 'measuring' and 'examining facts and figures' to ensure that it all stands up under scrutiny. However, if seen on their own, facts and figures can come across as 'cold' as the information is presented in terms of numbers and charts and data. The process will typically examine statistics and count details; how many sessions were offered, how many referrals were received, what funding was sourced and from where and from whom.

Hopefully reading this you will also be reminded that another aspect of the annual report is the opportunity it offers to acknowledge the stories behind the statistical information of twelve months. And in a place that exists to promote 'Hope, Healing and Growth', a place that is concerned with emotional health and wellbeing, the 'information' is not something cold, it is for the people of Fermanagh, the lives and the stories of neighbours managing difficult life events and emotions, of friends struggling to find ways to overcome and cope with recent or historic traumatic and upsetting experiences, and of family members coming to terms with long term physical and mental health problems.

The opportunity to provide a safe space for so many people who need it when 'the stories' become too much to manage alone is for all of us in the Aisling Centre a privilege. It is only possible because of the combined efforts of the Board of Directors, our Centre Co-ordinator, the volunteers, administrators, those who look after the building and the therapists who sit with our clients. It is a pleasure to work in a place and among people that hold the needs of others clearly in their sight, respecting each person as an individual. And while thanking them at the end of another year it is so important also to thank the huge numbers who came to the Aisling Centre, who took a risk and who trusted us at difficult times. We wish you well for the future.

John

Counselling, Psychotherapy and Play Therapy Service

In addition to a General/Personal Counselling and Psychotherapy service the Centre offers dedicated therapeutic service for:

- Adult Survivors of Childhood Abuse
- Victims/Survivors of the Troubles
- Adults living in the Enniskillen NRA area
- Play Therapy for Children Coping with Loss

Kay's Story

Kay was a middle-aged lady who came to therapy due to having a lot of stress and anxiety in her life. Kay was also having issues in her relationship which had been ongoing now for many years. She said she wanted to learn how to relax and be calm, to be free from the physical symptoms the anxiety was causing her such as rapid heartbeat and breathing, sweating, nausea/stomach upset, feeling dizzy/ lightheaded at times and experiencing a tightness or pain in her chest.

Over the first few weeks Kay spoke about the difficulties she had living with her partner who has a chronic drink problem. She spoke about the resentment and bitterness she felt towards him because of his drinking. She spoke of the worry and fear she had that he would kill himself because of his drinking and how she felt powerless to do anything about it.

We looked at Kay's way of thinking. She had lot of self-critical judgments about herself. These thoughts were having a negative impact on her frame of mind and self-esteem. We worked on her self-critical thinking and increasing self-compassion. This work focused on learning to identify negative and self-critical thoughts, assessing the honesty of these thoughts and developing more sensible and helpful ways of thinking. Kay soon realised that she was continuously berating herself, even for things that were nothing to do with her and that speaking to herself in this way was not very kind or caring. We looked at Kay's daily routine and how/what she could do to improve her quality of life as she lives in this environment. She learned about how anxiety also affects how we think. How anxious thoughts typically involve a fear of something bad happening and how when we are anxious, we tend to see the world as a threatening and dangerous place. Understanding that the problem with thinking and acting as if there is danger when there is no real danger is that she was feeling unnecessarily anxious.

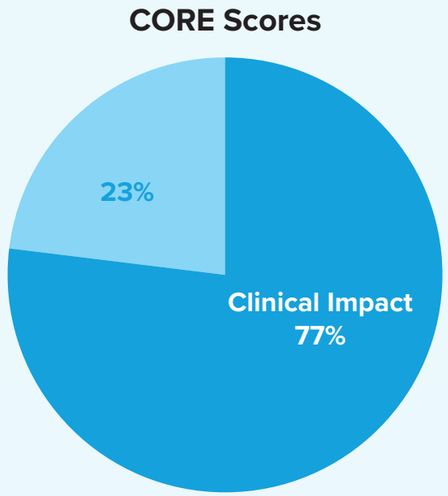
During these discussions Kay was able to allow herself to be open and honest about her true feelings, something she had never been able to do before or believed she ever could do as she was brought up in a strict environment where nobody was encouraged to talk about their feelings and the attitude was " just get on with it". She found this to be a really powerful and awakening experience.

So in creating a more balanced and kinder way of thinking and doing more for herself, she began to focus on what she could do, rather than trying to control what her husband was doing and her mood improved greatly. Through learning new ways of managing stressful situations like paying attention to her self-talk, identifying thoughts that lead to the anxiety, and evaluating and challenging her self-thinking along with mindfulness, deep breathing techniques etc, Kay not only felt better but now had the skills and information to manage her anxiety and stress and was very satisfied with the outcome of therapy.

Demand for counselling continues to rise. 655 requests for counselling were received an increase of 21% on last year. An average of 55 referrals per month was received, with numbers peaking at 83 in October and 77 in January.

An average of 110 counselling sessions per week was offered up from 96 per week last year an increase of 15%.

440 adults and 49 children received counselling/ psychotherapy/ play therapy

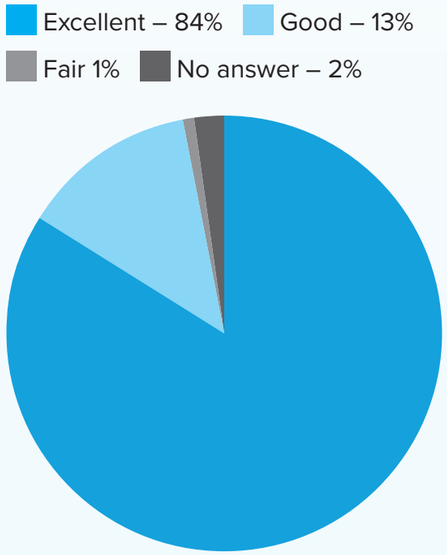


"I am grateful. It took a bit of courage to self-refer, but I am glad I did."

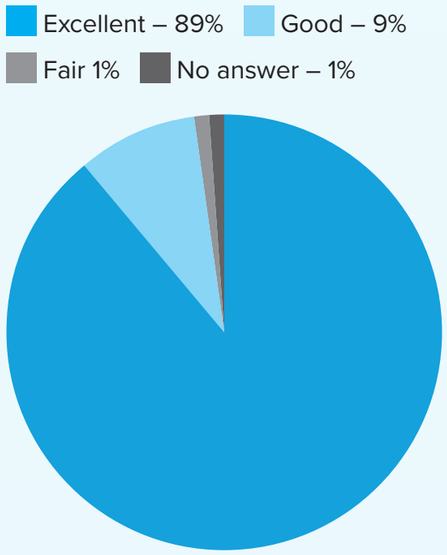
Counselling, Psychotherapy and Play Therapy Service

"The counselling was so helpful to me. Even though I was unsure as to how it would help me, talking through things with an impartial person was great. It gave me the time to think about and reflect on various areas in my life that was distressing me. Great service, thank you."

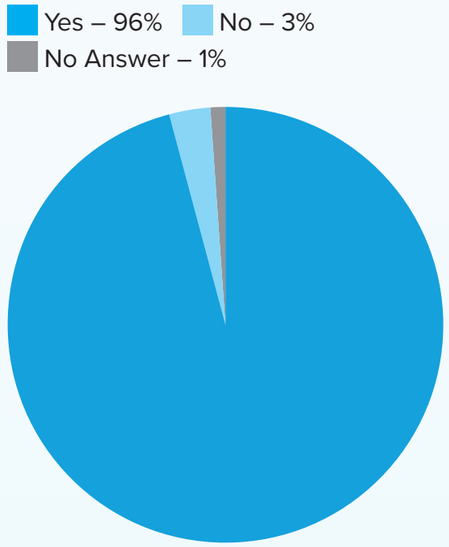
Overall experience of Centre



Level of Support received



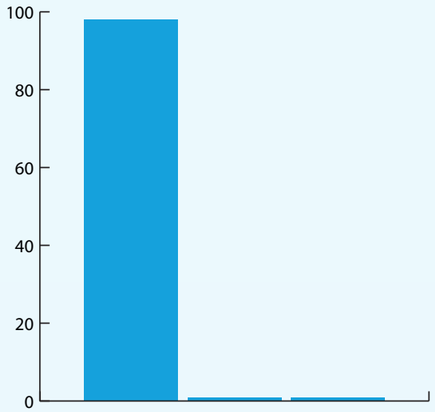
Feeling more positive about the future following counselling

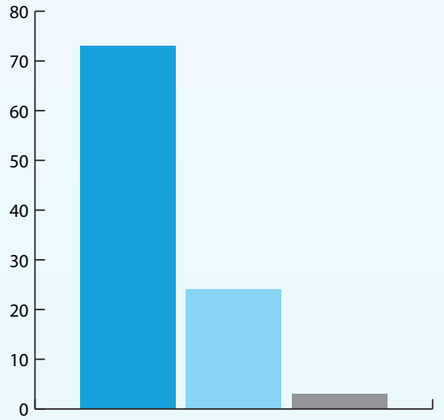


"This was my second time back at the Aisling Centre. Coming back was made easy for me due to the care I received. I can't thank my counsellor enough for his support and guidance through a difficult stage in my life."

98% of clients completing evaluations indicated significant levels of upset/distress before counselling:-

- 73% - High
- 24% - Moderate
- 3% - Mild





Reported levels of upset/distress following counselling:-

- 98% of clients saw a reduction in levels of upset/distress
- 1% had increased levels of distress/upset
- 1% experience no change in distress/upset levels

Counselling, Psychotherapy and Play Therapy Service

Ryan's Story

Ryan was a man in his 40s who came to counselling to try and deal with the loss of a family member who had died by suicide many years before. He had been trying to push his feelings down and felt that after all this time he should 'be ok by now'. It was becoming more and more difficult to do this and Ryan came to counselling feeling very low. He had lost all interest in things he used to enjoy and even found it difficult to be around friends and family. He described feeling very stuck and had never been able to speak much about his brother because it brought up too much emotion.

Gradually, in counselling, Ryan started to feel safe enough to speak about his loss, even though it was upsetting. Slowly he started to feel less uncomfortable about being upset and gave himself permission to grieve, which he realised he had never done before. He had coped with the aftermath of his brother's suicide, but had never slowed down enough to deal with how he felt about it. Through talking Ryan realised he held some strong judgements about himself: that he hadn't done enough and that he should feel guilty and ashamed that he hadn't saved his brother's life. He also felt that he didn't deserve to ever feel happy again because his brother would never be able to, which had led to him feeling so stuck – he felt he wasn't allowed to move on and was also scared to as well, in case him feeling more ok, meant that he had forgotten or didn't care about his brother any more.

After around five sessions of counselling, Ryan described deciding to let himself feel whatever he had hidden inside and things began to shift for him after a very powerful session where he just allowed feelings to come. He felt a weight had lifted from his shoulders and his heart and after this he could share more about his brother as a person, as well as how he had died, without becoming overwhelmed. Ryan left counselling feeling liberated, his difficult feelings hadn't all disappeared, but they were less intense and he felt more able to accept that they were there. He felt proud to have challenged himself so much and to have taken risks talking in counselling, in a way he had never spoken to anyone else before. He was relieved to be able to speak about his brother who he missed terribly and that missing him didn't mean Ryan couldn't also enjoy his own life, his children, family and friends. He felt he still had some work to do to deal with his grief, but was more ok about letting it happen in his own time and felt reassured that he could come back to counselling again in the future if he needed more support.

Client Feedback

What worked well?

"Welcoming, comfort, privacy."

"Just the whole professionalism of people and very helpful and understanding."

"Being able to sit and just talk and when I couldn't find the words not being pushed."

"Trusting who I spoke with about how I felt weekly."

"Just having a non-judgemental listening ear."

"The atmosphere was calm and welcoming. The receptionist was kind and reassuring. The waiting area was tranquil and peaceful."

"I always kept all my problems to myself; it was good to be able to talk of my problems with an excellent trained professional therapist."

"You were made very comfortable even though the first visit is daunting."

"Nice relaxing environment. Was put at ease and asked to just start telling my story. Amazed at how it was heard and understood."

Areas for improvement?

Feedback from clients about the service received was overwhelmingly positive; although some clients did comment on the length of waiting lists/times.

Joan's Story

Client self-referred due to anxiety and inability to concentrate at work. At assessment, she was off work for a few weeks and her anxiety had increased due mainly to a number of suicide attempts by someone close to her. She had become hyper-vigilant, withdrawn, unable to sleep and, her eating habits were poor. Her GP had prescribed anti-depressants.

Initially, time was given to her experiences of the trauma of the suicide attempts and the impact on her. Some psycho-education followed about trauma, triggers, flashbacks, nightmares and hyper-vigilance and suggestions about how to deal with these symptoms in a self-compassionate way.

Time was then given to client's relationship with her friend – what might be helpful and unhelpful in their present interaction. This was a difficult stage for client as she grappled with her persistent "worry" and how at times this caused the friend to be more "secretive" than open to her. Issues of boundaries, assertiveness, over involvement and trust were also raised. Using some CBT helped her to identify her patterns of thinking and to notice that there were other possibilities.

During the course of this work, ways of relaxing were suggested, eg breathing, mindfulness and self-care. This was difficult for the client whose only focus was on her friend's well being. In time, she began to see the importance of looking after herself.

At about the eight session, the client expressed that talking about her story and looking at the various issues was helping her. In particular she found the breathing exercises helped her to pause when she found herself in anxious place and remarked that coming to the quiet music in waiting area of Aisling Centre helped her to move from anxiety to relaxation and gaining the capacity to see a bigger picture.

In the course of the work, the client came to realise how tense, anxious and zealous she was at work, often taking on too much responsibility. As she began to return to phased work she sought clarity about her role /responsibilities and was more aware of her tendency to never say "no" which led to overwork, tiredness and resentment. Again this self-awareness was difficult but she was beginning to experience her ability to choose a response rather that feel controlled.

"I have had counselling in the past and have never felt that clicking into place of recognising my feelings and motivations. I'm very thankful."

General Feedback

"My upset and distress was off the scale when I first went to Aisling Centre, I was extremely mentally unfit and suicidal, I cannot express my gratitude to all the staff especially my counsellor. I have no doubt I'd be dead if I hadn't of had this service."

"I arrived with my counsellor a broken, distressed, depressed man - I wasn't suicidal but I was trying to get back on the path of life, and fair play to this lady who showed me the map and guided me back to a better life with a better outlook and positive attitude."

"This has been a highly rewarding experience for me and I could not have made the steps I have made in 12 weeks if it were not for feeling safe and relaxed while here. My counsellor has been wonderful and the fact that she done her job to beyond what I expected is why I leave here in a better place and feel like I can return anytime."

"I can't put into words how much this counselling session has been to me. It has helped me find myself again. I feel a sense of freedom in my life now. I will miss the calm environment of the Aisling Centre."

"Counsellor was very patient, understanding and supportive. Provided positive challenge to my way of looking at things; helped clarify choices and options and gave new insights. Feel I would benefit from the ability to come back for follow on sessions - if need arises, issues still ongoing."

"My counsellor was first class at her job, she has made me feel like I am a worthy and bright, amazing person and I understand now that my life experiences were not my fault. Could not thank her enough for what she has done for me."

"I feel less burdened by my issues, more focused on future happiness and I feel I am beginning to regain my inner strength that I thought I had lost."

I now have the tools to help myself. I so appreciate the help given to me. It has made me feel that I am a good person. I am so grateful for that."

GP led services & Outreach Provision

"I would like to take this opportunity to thank my counsellor for my counselling sessions as I feel in a much better place today, and also not forgetting my GP who referred me. Thanks again."

The Centre received referrals from all the GP practices across the county and works in partnership with five practices to provide an early intervention service for their Patients (LES Local Enhanced Service) –

- Maple Healthcare Group, Lisnaskea,
- Mallon & McConville Medical Practice, Enniskillen,
- Lakeside Medical Practice, Enniskillen,
- Dr McCaw & Partners, Irvinestown Health Centre
- Rathmore Clinic, Belleek.

On-site counselling was also available at

- Lisnaskea Health Centre
- Irvinestown Health Centre

"Really appreciated the availability of the counselling at my health centre, without having to travel to Enniskillen"

124 patients availed of counselling/psychotherapy through the GP LES service.

"I appreciated getting the counselling I needed at the right time for me and I'd like to help by doing Fundraising to help others get their counselling"

"I really appreciate all the help I received from the Aisling Centre. I don't know how I would have coped during the past number of traumatic months without it. Many thanks. Will always be grateful."

"Thank you for a kind, listening ear and for all your patience, I'm so glad I stuck with this process."

James's Story

Client was referred by GP due to depression, the onset being when some physical health problems were identified. The client had been off work for a number of weeks when he came for assessment and was missing his work routine. While he was anxious about his health, he indicated that the death of a childhood friend was shattering and left him very angry. He was also concerned about care for elderly relatives. He was attending his GP for medical reasons and had also been prescribed anti-depressants.

During the initial sessions, the client spoke about his friend and how they had supported each other during school, work, and broken relationships. It seemed as if it was important for this man to speak about the various difficulties he experienced at different stages of his life, especially his marriage breakup and now, his grief about his friend. This evoked many feelings in client of sadness, anger, loss and frustration.

On the fourth session, the client, almost in an outburst, told how both he and his friend had been abused as young boys. This shared experience and secret had bonded the two boys/men but now he felt rage about what happened and also that his friend was gone.

The next few sessions involved being with this man as he expressed his almost uncontrollable sadness and rage. The impact of the abuse was explored – inability to tell, his loss of interest in school, his impulsivity/anger in situations, his sexual difficulties and lack of trust. The client gained awareness that because of some of these reactions/ behaviours his self-esteem was always low. We spent some time naming the real person's qualities/ strengths/abilities.

The client appreciated the relief he felt in opening up for the first time about his abuse and became aware that some of his depression was about the anger and hurt he tried to conceal. He came to understand some of the impulsive behaviour, fear and mistrust. (As the perpetrator is deceased the client can't pursue it legally, but believes he would never have been believed.)

This was a difficult journey and the work was incomplete but client knows that he can avail of counselling at another time if he wishes to continue the work.

Counselling, Psychotherapy and Play Therapy Service

Play Therapy Service

49 children and young people attended Counselling and Play Therapy. 94% were children coping with loss and 6% were children dealing with the transgenerational impact of the troubles.

Counselling/Play Therapy took place in the Aisling Centre and also on an outreach basis from Primary Schools across the County and at the Oak HLC.

Parent/Care Giver feedback

"My child was only 5 when his father left the family home. He was inconsolable. He thought his mum was going to leave him as well. Therapist has made him look at positive things and goals for the future and now he has a more positive outlook."

"Therapist has done amazing work with my son and I cannot thank her enough. He is a happy, confident little boy now and he enjoyed his sessions so much. The service provided to my son has completely changed his outlook. Therapist has also helped us come up with strategies to help him cope now that his sessions are ending. Thank you so much."

"More feedback from sessions, I understand it is confidential but it is very hard to understand what is going on if no-one can give you an insight into the problem."

"My child was so worried about death that everything was making him cry and worried. Now he isn't as worried and rarely cries about death. He still asks about certain people and what age they were when they died, but in general, a lot happier. Thanks."

"Therapist and place are friendly, warm, inviting, puts you at ease straight away."

Schools Feedback

"Facilitation work in the school has been hugely beneficial, as was contact with staff on a regular basis"

"Service brought about change for the good and in the child's best interests"

"Therapist worked with professionalism at all times ensuring confidentiality of what was going on. Positive outcomes overall for the child - very worthwhile intervention"

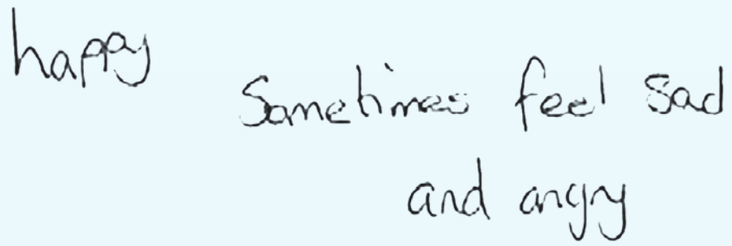
"I feel child has really benefitted from the play therapy sessions this year. He appears to be calmer and more content"

"Play therapy has been a wonderful resource in meeting the emotional needs of this child. The opportunity to have a safe space to engage on a 1-1 basis with an empathetic adult has made an immeasurable difference. Therapist has many fine qualities which she brings to her role and we are very grateful for her generosity and for her thoughtful approach. We were blessed to have such a skilled practitioner."

Child Feedback

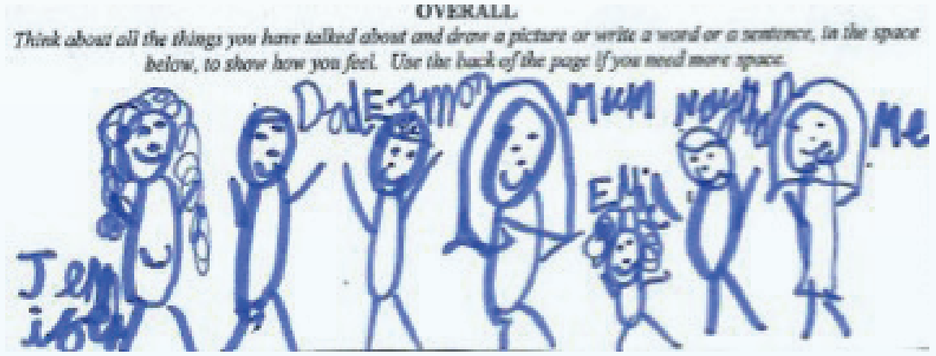


"At the start it felt a bit strange because 'therapist' was a stranger to me. Then I got to know her better and I felt happy because I was telling her my feelings."

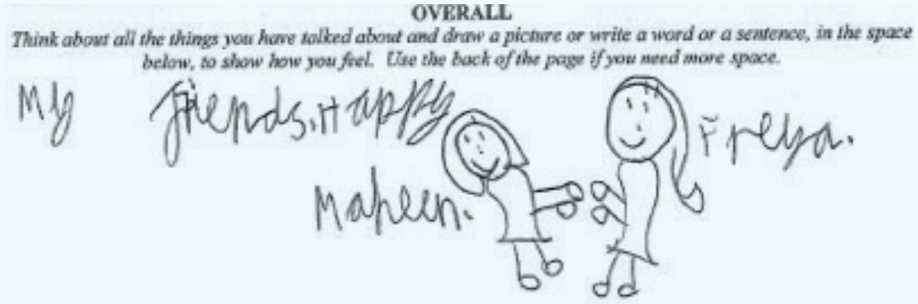


"It helped because she and I had a meeting with daddy and he understood that my feelings were hurt. It has been better staying at dad's. She gives me ideas to help me sleep better at dad's."

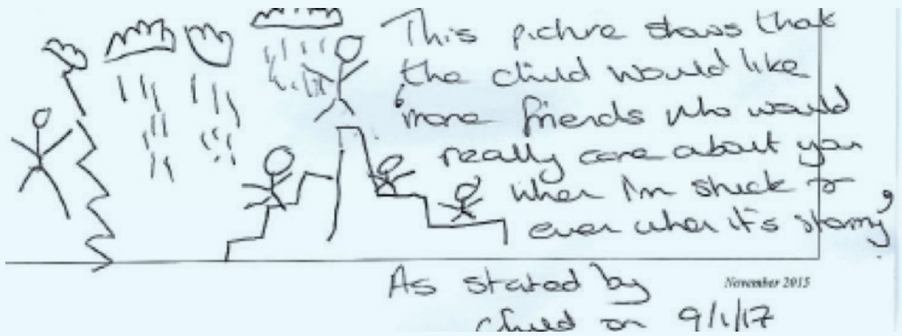
Counselling, Psychotherapy and Play Therapy Service



"It made it all better, there's less unwanted in it. I don't feel unwanted. I feel less stressed because I've been talking to someone about the difficulty I had with a family member gone."



"When my daddy stopped seeing me it made me feel unwanted, forgotten, sad and angry. I want the service to help me be ok about it to feel less angry and not take it out on anyone."



Diane's Story

Diane is an 11 year old girl who lives with her daddy and an older sibling. Diane's parents are separated and relations between them continue to be strained and conflictual. Diane has regular contact with her mummy every week. Diane was referred into the 'Children coping with Loss' programme by the principal of the primary school she attended, due to the stress that she felt Diane was experiencing as a result of her parental separation.

At the initial assessment session, attended by Diane and her father, Diane was able to independently speak about herself, her experiences and some feelings around these. Many times it becomes clear that it has been an adult's decision for a child to attend therapy, but it was very clear in this first session that Diane had her own reasons for coming. Both Diane and her daddy spoke about family tensions and the pressure Diane was feeling as a result of this, as well as their wish for Diane to have her own private space to make sense of it all.

Diane attended an agreed number of sessions and reviews were held with both parents individually. As the sessions progressed, Diane had the opportunity to explore her thoughts and feelings around her parents' separation and the impact she felt it had on her and her sibling. Through creative pieces such as art and exercises such as letter writing, Diane explored her family relationships and as she did this, she became more confident in articulating the present difficulties, including why she felt it hard to share these with her parents. As the sessions progressed Diane was able to discover the changes that she needed and ways to help these come about. As each review occurred with a parent, Diane was increasingly more able to address the issues with them and to ask for the support she needed.

At the beginning of therapy, Diane often spoke about the need to be able to have her own space, away from her family, sometimes, to be able to freely process her thoughts and feelings. At the end of her therapy she continued to make reference to this, highlighting this as one of the differences therapy made for her. Diane also spoke of the realisations that occurred through her explorations of self and family, during therapy which has changed the way she approaches things with her parents. In his feedback Diane's father also spoke of her new found confidence in expressing her needs to her parents and, how therapy helped her to discover other ways of coping with her feelings which doesn't involve feeling she always has to please both parents.

Counselling, Psychotherapy and Play Therapy Service

Service for Victims & Survivors of the Troubles

Nigel's Story

I live with my family though some of them have now grown up and moved away. Over a few years I had gotten a lot quieter and spent more time on my own. After a lot of nudging from them at home I went to my doctor and told him about being quiet and spending time on my own, but I didn't have a reason. The doctor told me I was physically well but he thought it might be good if I talked with someone and that he would arrange it for me.

And that's how, on a cold and wet and dark morning, I first came to the Aisling Centre to meet with a counsellor. I arrived with nothing in my mind to say but just because the doctor thought it was a good thing to do, I did it. I sat in the waiting area for about 5 or 10 minutes and with nothing to do I listened to the music and read all the notices on the big notice board right in front of me and there something happened.

I went in to the counsellor and began to speak about a poster on the noticeboard that asked 'have you been affected by the troubles?' and I began to cry without any control. Up to then I don't think I knew what 'affected by the troubles meant' and in that moment it was a like a light was switched on. I was affected by the troubles! And that's where the counsellor stepped in and helped me to stop it from ruining or maybe even ending my life. How do you say thank you for that?

The phrase 'The Troubles' is one we use regularly to speak about a period of time of political unrest, a phrase that has become very much part of our everyday language. The commonplace use of the word can distract us from the activities and atmosphere of that period of time, an atmosphere and, activities that we see have impacted on the mental health of many people, an impact that we can now see passed on through the generations.

And while the period of time we speak about might be in the past tense, the negative impact of that time on an individual's mental health is something that lives in the present; it is today that many still struggle emotionally.

It is a rewarding part of our history that since we opened our doors in 1990, The Aisling Centre has provided services for Victims and Survivors of the Troubles. That important part of our service to all the people of Fermanagh has been supported since 2003, initially through the Community Relations Council, Strategic Support Fund and currently by the Victims Support Programme. Counselling, Psychotherapy and Complementary therapy is available.

Susan's Story

Susan is an elderly woman who presented for counselling due to the recent death of her husband. Susan's husband had been shot during the early years of the troubles resulting in him being severly disabled. This was coupled with the fact that Susan had young children at the time. Susan's life changed. We contracted to do twelve weeks of counselling, same place, same time every week.

Session 1 to 3

Susan presents her history and transgenerational history giving insight into her family of origin. She came from a hard working family where although there was not much money about, was seeped in a loving, moralistic, and, supportive family. She left home early to work and married young. The shooting of her husband meant that Susan was largely left with all the responsibilities. For the next 40 plus years she was a carer to what transpired to be a very difficult and angry man. Susan is in a lot of physical pain as well as emotional pain as all the lifting and physical hardship has taken its toll on her body. In these first sessions the ground work was set for deeper work.

Session 3 to 6

Susan fell in the third week and had to pick herself up and go home to an empty house. The emptiness and the lonely space brought home to Susan her grief. It also let Susan know how angry she was. She felt guilty that she had all these angry feelings. She also became aware that her feelings had to take second or third place behind those of her husband and children. "I had to get on with it" Susan said. She never expected to be left so desolate and alone. Two of her children are supportive and Susan sees them weekly.

Sessions 6 to 9

Susan has attended every session and this indicates that the work is important to her. We have a good rapport which enables trust and openness. Susan has got herself a dog and already this brings a smile to her face. Her husband's gravestone has gone up and this difficult for Susan when she goes to the cemetery. Talks now about other anxieties, like her finances and fears of bills and outgoings, has made an appointment to see the welfare person at CAB. Also talking more about the lack of closure for her in relation to the people who shot her husband. Nobody was ever was caught and convicted.

Sessions 9 to 12

The final three weeks of counselling brought a joining up of all the threads of the work together. Susan felt relief that she had the opportunity to talk about her world and the conflicts it wrought upon her. Also, because of the process it meant that on this occasion there was a beginning, middle and end. Susan still has some fears and anxieties, and, she knows too that someone can listen to her story.

If you feel 'the Troubles' have had an effect on your mental or emotional wellbeing, do call in to us in confidence.

Service for Victims & Survivors of the Troubles

Well-Being & Life Learning Services

Complementary Therapy

99 clients were referred to CT

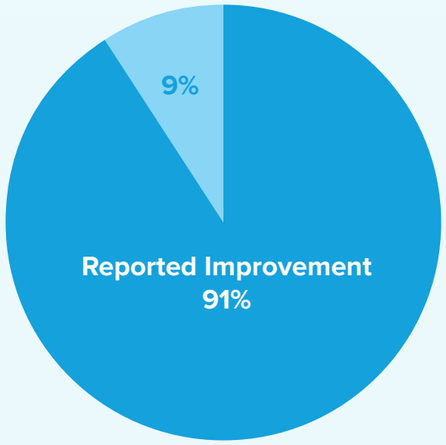
- 69% presented as victims/survivors of the troubles
- 5% clients were dealing with the aftermath of suicide
- 26% presented with general stress/anxiety

Main Presenting Issues

16% - Depression/Low Mood	15% - Stress
16% - Anxiety	21% - Joint Pain
3% - Sleep problems	10% -Fatigue/lethargy/Low Energy
4% - Grief	1% - Isolation
1% - Fear	13% - Other

95% of clients recommend for CT completed 6 sessions.

MyMop Impact Scores



Feedback from all clients who completed 6 sessions was overwhelmingly positive.

The recurring themes noted improved mood, more positive outlook, reduced stress and anxiety levels, reduced pain, time out for people caring for others, support through difficult times, time out of the house and contact with others and improved sleep patterns.

- 81% reported improved mental health and emotional wellbeing
- 60% reported improvement in physical symptoms eg improved sleep patterns, reduced or more manageable pain etc

Client Feedback:-

"I loved my sessions; they were something for me to look forward to as I have ongoing stress and depression. They help me cope through the dark periods and help me to relax and stay focused and calm."

"Found sessions very relaxing and enjoyable - helped me release emotional turmoil, very beneficial for my emotional and mental health and well-being."

"Really enjoyed programme, it left me more active physically, less pains in my legs and feet, helped my mental health immensely. Treatments great for my stress levels."

"I loved my sessions they have helped me mentally, emotionally and physically through a very distressing time. I feel my energy coming back and my mood has lifted. The therapist was so understanding. I get great night's sleep after session."

"These sessions were a God send, a time of quiet and peace for me, my care and my haven. My husband has Alzheimer's, I was at my wits end but with the help of the staff of Aisling Centre I am starting to get out a little myself. The stress is on-going but the treatments have helped carry me through a very difficult time."

Well-Being & Life Learning Services

Mindfulness Meditation – Power and Freedom

Mindfulness practices at the Aisling Centre include monthly drop-in taster and practice sessions, the 8-Week MBSR programme and Day Silent Retreat. The programme has proved so popular that we are planning to work with the Bangor University, Wales and the support of the Mercy Fund to train up 5 new Mindfulness Teachers in 2018.

Karen's Story

I was attracted to the Mindfulness course for a number of years, but always seemed to find a reason not to enrol. I thought I hardly needed to attend a course to learn how to concentrate on breathing and surely Mindfulness can't be that difficult, however, my DIY attempts were short-lived and not very successful.

I joined the Aisling Centre Mindfulness class with facilitator, Mary Conway and I was struck by the diversity of people in the room. It turned out though, that we had more similarities than differences. It seemed we all wanted to live with a bit more ease. As Mary introduced the mindfulness exercises however, many of us resisted them – finding reasons why they did not suit us/fit in with our particular lifestyles. I'm sure Mary had heard all the excuses before but you would never have guessed. It gradually dawned on many of us, that Mindfulness, though in many ways simple, wasn't easy and there were no short cuts. Mary was a wonderful teacher and she was able to expertly steer us towards an awareness of the obstacles we were placing in our own way. Every week more and more participants came on board and could see the value of persevering with the practices and embracing the basic principle of 'being present'.

The bonds within the group deepened and a lovely atmosphere of fun, friendship and acceptance developed. Mary introduced us to Victor Frankl's quote that in some ways became the group's moto:

'Somewhere between a stimulus and a response is a space and in that space is our power and freedom'.

A year on from the course, I still value the CDs we were given to help us keep up the practice and my family have become accustomed to Mary's hushed tones being transmitted from behind closed doors! I got an enormous power and freedom from doing this course and I recommend it to many people in my personal and professional life on an ongoing basis.

MBSR Participant

MBSR Programme

Participant Feedback

Feedback on programmes offered this year was overwhelmingly positive.

Participants were asked if after completing the programme they felt better able to cope with:-

- Any physical illness or pain or mental ill-health they might be living with
- *Any things in their life that might be causing them stress/anxiety or any difficult situation they might be living with.*
- 90% felt better able to cope
- 5% felt somewhat better able to cope
- 5% reported no improvement

Feedback on programme delivery

	Excellent	Good	Poor
Relevance of contents	82%	18%	n/a
Facilitation	95%	5%	n/a
Usefulness of materials provided	100%	n/a	n/a
Value of learning through group experience	77%	23%	n/a

100% of participants indicated that they would incorporate mindfulness into their daily lives.

Participant Comments:-

"Was initially sceptical of mindfulness, have been transformed and converted. Will sorely miss my Wednesday night MBSR class."

"The sessions for me were so helpful. The opportunity to discuss different themes that emerged was useful."

"The introductory evening worked brilliantly putting me at ease. It's comforting to know you are not alone in the journey."

"Liked the way you were never 'made' to speak or never put on the spot."

Well-Being & Life Learning Services

"Learning how to relax really helped with my digestion."

"The CD is invaluable - without it one couldn't remember the exercises. It stills the body and mind."

"With time, meditating every night, I have come to address emotions that were uncomfortable for me."

"Initially I found it hard to stay focused but once I went into 4th week taking my mind back to the breath totally relaxed me."

"I have taken more control about making decisions in my life. Realise that this is only the start of a road that I intend to work on and become better at enjoying life more."

"Each week no matter how busy or stressful -the class was a welcome focus and relief."

8-Week Mindfulness Based Stress Reduction Programme (MBSR)

Spring & Autumn Programmes

Dates to be Confirmed

Monthly Drop-in Taster & Practice Development Sessions

Normally the last Tuesday of the month

7.30 – 9.00pm

Contact Centre for details



Hope, Healing & Health

On Saturday 6th of January 2018 - a unique day of inspiration was held to start the New Year on a positive note to ensure that every good intention, to make the coming year the best it could be, would be realised. The Hope, Healing and Health event aimed to help everyone stick to those resolutions while supporting the work of the Aisling Centre.

Organised by the dynamic HHH team of Aideen, Maureen, Sheila and Noelle, the event was held in Fermanagh House and was structured around the three core themes of Hope, Healing and Health and comprised of keynote speeches, workshops, complementary therapies and creative sessions.

A particular theme of the presentations was how the speakers had overcome personal adversity and transformed their lives around by facing their issues in a positive way and harnessing what they had learned to benefit others. Presenters on the day included Declan Coyle, Karen Dwyer, Iain Cameron, Patrick J Durey, Sarah Griffiths, Glen Hinds, Melanie Kennedy and Chris Rintoul. All the speakers and therapists gave of their time and talents on a voluntary basis.

This unique event created an opportunity locally, for over 400 people, to hear at first hand personal stories of everyday miracles in a day of reflection, relaxation and restoration; to sample different healing approaches; enjoy the positivity of the event and to be inspired in their own life journey. The day exceeded all expectations and in the words of Declan Coyle "gratitude was the central theme that orchestrated the amazing energy of the whole day".

A Gift of Hope, Health and Healing



Saturday January 5th 2019

(2nd Annual Day of Inspiration)

10am – 5pm in the South West College Technology & Skills Centre, Killyhevlin Industrial Estate, Enniskillen, BT74 4EJ, Co Fermanagh

Tickets £15

Tickets available from
Aisling Centre 02866325811
South West College 02882250109
Tech Doc, Enniskillen on 02866500750

Presentations

Declan Coyle - *The Green Platform.*

Cathy McCarthy - *Facing adversity.*

Karen Dwyer – *Be your own superhero.*

Marie Dunne - *Renew, reclaim, refresh your life.*

Self-Care & Resilience Seminars & Workshops
Complementary Therapy Taster Sessions

Inspiring Speakers share their life stories

MS, Post Natal Depression, Anorexia Nervosa, Addiction, Bereavement, Cancer and Stress.

One-year on with ***Sarah Griffiths*** *"Wheelie Momma "*
and ***Melanie Kennedy*** *"Cancer Warrior "*

Creative sessions and performances including
Andrea Begley *Winner of THE VOICE*

All proceeds from the event are going to The Aisling Centre which promotes positive mental health and emotional well-being.
http://www.theaislingcentre.com



The importance of the Aisling Centre as a vital resource in the community and a beacon of hope was consistently highlighted in the feedback. Aisling Centre, Clinical Coordinator, John Bennett, read a letter from a client whose life was turned around by the support they had received. This poignant, firsthand testimony highlighted the importance of the work of the centre, over the past 28 years, in helping thousands of people through the professional counselling, psychotherapy and well-being services provided.

"You have taken me and put all the broken bits back together one by one.... For the first time in years I am hopeful about my future"

The event was so successful that a second event is now planned – 5th January 2019 South West College, Skills Centre, Dublin Road, Enniskillen. Tickets £15, are on sale now.

Aideen HHH Team



The Secret of the Pooja Bear



There is a VERY special secret
in a VERY special place
that only VERY special people can see
And only VERY special people will know.
Can you guess the secret?
Are you one of these VERY special people?
The POOJA Bears want to meet you
and give you a big hug.

The Pooja bears have a very special secret. They live in the floorboards of St Michael's Church just up the street from the Aisling Centre.

Having been on a Habitat build to India inspired by this and the work of Schools for Hope programme run by the Aisling Centre, Aideen McGinley a Director of the Centre decided to write a children's book encouraging parents to spend time with their children reading the stories and, each day reflecting positively together on what their day had been like and looking forward positively to what was to come.

The Pooja Bears are named after a little girl who lives in the BAWANN slum in New Delhi, a place close to Aideen's heart. And, Aideen has very generously donated all the proceeds from the book to two charities, the Aisling Centre and Habitat For Humanity NI, to help children and families in India and Fermanagh.

'The Secret of the Pooja Bears: Angle Voices and Candle Light' is available in paperback or kindle from Amazon UK.



Farewell



It was with much regret that Directors and Staff at the Aisling Centre said goodbye to their colleague and friend, Jackie Stretch, as she left her psychotherapy position at the Centre to return to live and work in England.

Jackie first came to work at the Aisling Centre in 2003 and quickly made work with Victims and Survivors of the NI Troubles her specialism. She gave dedicated service working hard to understand trauma from their unique and very particular perspective. The calibre of her work was borne out by the feedback received from her clients:

"I would like to thank Jackie for helping me through a really difficult time. I was in a really dark place and she helped me come out of it. I still have some days when I don't feel great but I remember things Jackie said to me which helps me through them. Thank you Aisling Centre!!!"

After 14 years' work at the Aisling Centre Jackie is missed by all. We thank her for the many years of friendship and support. We hope her 'new' adventure 'back home' is going well.



Treasurer's Report



The challenge of keeping the Aisling Centre running continues during this financial year. A difficult economic climate and much political uncertainty combine to provide a challenging back-drop to providing high standards in our work. However a hard-working staff and strong leadership have produced a pleasing financial report that provides a strong foundation for the years ahead. As always we have been most fortunate in terms of our funders, regional, local and national. This requires significant administrative support through our energetic office team and the volunteers who play a big role in releasing them for other duties.

This year we have received financial support from the Western Health and Social Care Trust, Victims and Survivors Service, BBC Children in Need, Public Health Agency, Belfast Cathedral Sit-Out and Mercy Funds. We have been also grateful for financial support from the NRA, PCSP and FODC as well as St John of God Foundation. This support has ensured consistent, high quality service to those most in need within our society.

We also thank our amazing Aisling Centre Fund Raising Team. Working with focus and determination this small team has really made a difference to the Centre's funds in the last year. Thanks also to the many in the community who have supported us - walks, runs, cycles, vintage events and coffee mornings as well as street collections, bake sales and car washes have all helped raise much need funds for the Centre.

The Centre has been fortunate to offer facilities to a wide range of users who have hired rooms in the Centre. This means the use of the Centre goes well beyond the normal 9-5 working day and most nights sees groups from all backgrounds using the rooms. This is a vital resource in our community and provides a practical link between groups and the Centre they use.

Finally we must thank the Sisters of Mercy for the use of the lovely building in Darling Street. Their continued support and prayer for our work cannot be underestimated.

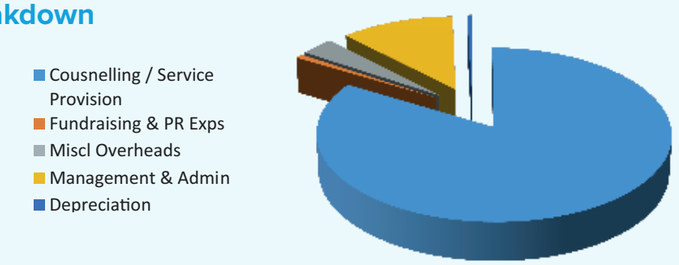
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Funding Acknowlegements

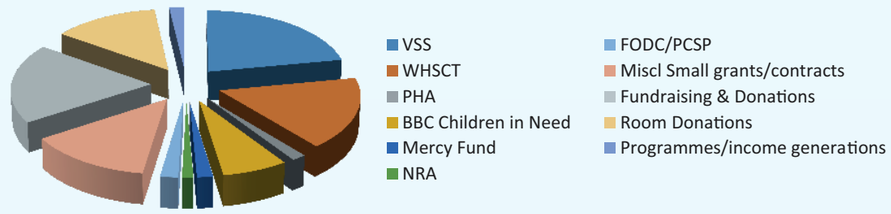
Western Health and Social Care Trust
Public Health Agency
Policing & Community Safety Partnerships
making our community safer
Fermanagh & Omagh District Council
Comhairle Ceantair Fhear Manach agus na hÓmaí
BBC Children in Need
VICTIMS & SURVIVORS SERVICE
BELFAST CATHEDRAL
SAINT JOHN OF GOD FOUNDATION
NEIGHBOURHOOD RENEWAL
Mercy Projects Fund (NI)

It should be noted that all ideas, opinions and comments included in this report are entirely the responsibility of the report author and do not necessarily represent or reflect funder policy.

Expenditure Breakdown



Income Breakdown



Community Hub Services / Programmes

Counselling Services

ZEST – Healing the Hurt
SHIP – Counselling and support for people who self-harm
For information contact your GP or contact ZEST on 028 71 266999
www.zestni.org

Support Groups and Networks

AA - 3 meetings per week
For information contact the Aisling Centre – 028 6632 5811

ADHD - Adult support group
1st Thursday of the Month 7:00pm – 9:00pm
For information contact – Niall Greene or Emma Weaver
t: 07729618563 | 07724916770 |
e: niaadhd@gmail.com

AWARE- A self-help support group-for people who are affected by depression or bipolar disorder (manic depression).
Alternative Tuesdays 7:30pm – 9:00pm
For information contact - 0845 120 2961 -
e: help@aware-ni.org

Escapists - Support group for carers
Wednesday mornings 10:30am – 1:00pm
For information contact – Clare McGovern 078 3011 7766

Ethnic Communities Support Group
Free advice & advocacy service
Available by appointment, every second Tuesday 10am – 4pm
For information contact - Karolina Wenta
028 8224 9750
Email: oecsg2@yahoo.co.uk

Forget Me Not - Support group for people bereaved by suicide
1st Monday of the Month 7:30pm – 9:00pm
For information contact – Colette Cullen
078 2653 5199

SWEDES (South West Enabling Deaf Encouraging Sign) –
Deaf, hard of hearing, hearing and signing social network
2nd Tuesday of the month 7:30pm – 9:00pm
For information contact – Joan Thompson
028 6632 5811

Workshops and Classes

Island Artists -
Wednesday afternoons 2.00pm – 4.00pm
For information contact – Maura Newman – 079 6822 5704

Yoga – Monday 6.30pm – 7.30pm – Alasdair McKay
For information contact - Alasdair McKay – 077 7629 0903
Thursdays 11.30am – 1pm
For information contact - Jenni Brown
028 8954 1994
Thursday 6:30pm – 7:30pm
For information contact – Christina Cornyn – 077 2255 0040

Other Services

Cherish Sure Start - Crèche
For information contact Maeve Linton – 028 6632 3153 - 028 6862 1970

Westend Coffee Shop
Monday – Saturday 8:00am – 5:00pm
Café & Outside Catering
For information contact Barry –
028 6634 0475 / 0797997 5000

Every year 50+ organisations and Individuals use Aisling Centre as base from which to deliver programmes & services we thank them sincerely for their on-going support.

AA Serenity Prayer

God, grant me the serenity to accept the things I cannot change, the courage to change the things I can, and the wisdom to know the difference.

My life as an alcoholic

I started drinking at about 15 or 16 years of age.

Looking back now I can see there was something wrong from the beginning, alcohol made me sick, but I still drank it. If it was food that had done it I don't think I would have ever eaten the same food again.

I was addicted to alcohol from the first drink.

First I only drank at weekends, at night. I got into a lot of trouble with drink. I started to drink on Saturday and Sunday daytimes and not go to work on Mondays. I was barred out of lots of pubs. I was violent. I also had blackouts. I left a lot of worry on my parents, not coming home at night.

I tried to stop drinking; tried controlling it – tried changing drinks, not drinking spirits, only beers, shandy etc – but the obsession was there full time, drink was controlling me.

I was full of defects, resentment, anger and self-pity, selfish and self-centred. I was depressed, worried, lonely and fearful. I couldn't sleep. I didn't want to live. I didn't like to be the person I was. I had no life and everyone thought it was just badness.

I was sleeping in the pub one day when someone woke me and asked me to try AA (Alcoholics Anonymous) they were going for a short time and it was working for them. I said at the time that I would try anything so, I agreed to go to an AA meeting on the Thursday night. It was in Bundoran. As sick as I was, I was full of pride and didn't want to be seen going to a local meeting (although I didn't mind being seen banging down the pub door). The fear I had going to that meeting was unreal.

As soon as I went in the door I felt something. At the time I didn't know what it was but today I know it was hope. I was told I was the most important person in the room that night. I thought they were all crazy or mad. I had been barred out of about 18 pubs. It was the first time in my life I was told that I was important

Community Hub Services / Programmes

anywhere. I understand now that this was because it brought everyone's minds back to their first meeting.

I soon realised that there was some people there a lot worse than me and some people a lot better than me and that I was probably somewhere in the middle and I realised then I had no option but to stay and give it a try. I was told it was a simple programme but not an easy one - just stay away from the first drink for one day at a time and give it an honest try. The only requirement for AA membership is a desire to stop drinking.

Alcoholism - after some time going to meetings I accepted that I was an alcoholic, – realising that the 'alcohol' was in the bottle and the 'ism' was in me. I also accepted that working the AA programme would be the hardest thing I would ever do for myself. I went to a lot of meetings, it has given me a new life, hope, peace, love, freedom, courage. I no longer feel alone – the complete opposite to what my life was like.

I always thought that that there was something wrong with me, that I was different to the rest of the family. I always thought that the rest of them got more attention than me; for example better toys. I was jealous. Everyone around me was wrong; my parents, where I lived, everything. I thought everyone else my own age was better treated than me. I struggled at school. I could never learn. As a child I had a lot of fear in me, fear of school, getting summer holidays in June meant worrying about going back in September, always fearful, always worrying about the future, even from an early age.

The AA programme helped me realise that I had loving parents – the saying is "you can't see until you can see" – I realised how good a parents I had and what they had done for me and was able to tell them that before they died - all down to the support and help of AA.

AA asks for honesty, open-mindedness and willingness – Once the booze was gone I realised that there was so much wrong in my life; that was the toughest part. The number one defect I had was resentment; resentment against people. It was like taking poison myself and expecting them to die. I was like the tale of the man in his office trying to work but his 6 year old child was distracting him, so he took a large map of the world off the wall, tore it up into little pieces and told the child to go and put it together again. The child quickly pieced the map together. When the man was surprised at how quickly the child did this, the child explained that there was a picture of a man on the back of the map "daddy it was easy, when I got the man right, the world was right".

I was in my early twenties when I went to AA and the man that brought me a year younger. An old timer sat the two of us down and told us to give it an honest try as he had been drinking for over 40 years, as long as the two of us had lived. He told us we had choice, "there are no bosses in AA and the door swings both ways".

Today I know alcoholism is a killer disease mentally, physically and spiritually. I thought I was a bad person, now I know I was a sick person and I keep going to AA meetings on a regular basis. I am no longer alone.

The most important thing I discovered is to live a day at a time because if I live in the yesterday I'm depressed and if I live in the tomorrow I am anxious. If I live in today I have peace of mind.

Alcoholism is a disease. It is a cunning, baffling and powerful disease and without help it is too much for us.

Anon

In AA, everyone is equal and it's anonymous, members are known by their first name only. There is a little slogan "Who you see here, what you hear here, let it stay here"

AA meets in the Aisling Centre three evenings per week; Monday, Tuesday and Thursday. Meetings are open to anyone struggling with addiction. For information contact the Centre on 028 66 325811



Westend Coffee Shop

Café & Outside Catering

Monday – Saturday 8:00am – 5:00pm

For information contact Barry

028 6634 0475 / 079 79975000

Community Hub Services / Programmes

Ethnic Communities Support Group

Based in Communities House Omagh, Omagh Ethnic Communities Support Group (OECSG) provides support to the growing number of ethnic minority members coming to live in the Fermanagh & Omagh District Area.

We are committed to promoting respect for ethnic diversity in a community that is free of racism and discrimination and where equality is guaranteed.

We offer interpreter supported advice services.

Services

- To develop and improve the quality of life of the different minority ethnic communities living within the Fermanagh Omagh District Council area
- To identify individuals/groups needs and to address these needs
- To provide capacity training to individuals and groups
- To develop health programmes and organise social events and activities to ease isolation and loneliness
- To increase employability prospects through training and support programmes.

Established in Omagh in 1998 OECSG extend their outreach service to Fermanagh in 2017.

Services are available from the Aisling Centre, Enniskillen every second Tuesday from 10 am – 4 pm. For further information or to make an appointment contact us on 028 8224 9750.

Enniskillen Dates - 2018

6th November, 20th November, 4th December & 18th December.

Community Plan Update

Fermanagh Omagh 2030 Community Plan

The Community Plan for the district 'Fermanagh and Omagh 2030' was published in March 2017 and the supporting Action Plan in March 2018. Since then work has been progressing to progress delivery of actions. The first Performance Report setting out progress achieved is due to be published by November 2019".

Community Planning Themes and Outcomes

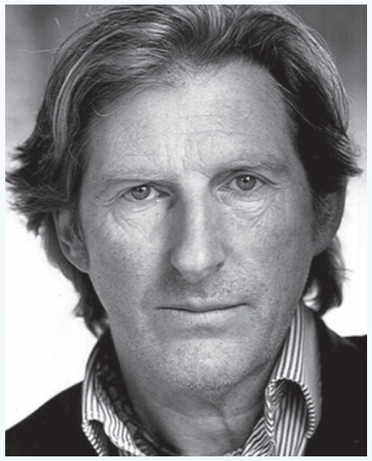


Aisling Centre is a member the Community Voluntary Sector Forum and a community representative on the People and Places action.

Full Community plan available to download from FODC website.

Meet the Team

Patron



Adrian Dunbar

Board of Directors

Ann McDermott
Chairperson

Alison Annan
Vice-Chairperson

Mary Delacy
Secretary

Neville Armstrong
Treasurer

Directors

Aideen McGinley
Iain Kennedy
Pat Cassidy
Edel Bannon
Mary Delacy
Roberta Hamilton



Board Members. Edel Bannon and Pat Cassidy are missing from the photo.

Staff

Bridie Sweeney -
Centre Co-ordinator

John Bennett -
Clinical Co-ordinator

Patricia Kelly -
Admin / Facilitates Manager

Clinical Team

Clare Love
Edel McGuiness
Jackie Stretch - left July 2017
Mary Carroll
Nuala McGovern
Sharon Fitzpatrick

Sessional Psychotherapists

Aine Wilson
Ann Farrell
Anna Frith
Brenda Wynne-McKervey
Helen Murphy
Holly Reid
Joni Crone
Karen Whaley
Nicholas May
Teresa Mckenna

Administration Team

Jimmy Britton
Joan Thompson
Marie Greene
Caroline Scott
Vivienne Kells

Group Facilitators

Aine Wilson
Mary Conway
Mary Daly

Sessional CT

Sheila Johnston

Volunteers

Bronagh Reilly, Margaret Corrigan, Regina Henderson, Rita Murphy

We would also like to acknowledge the role of our friends, too many to mention individually, who play an invaluable role in supporting the awareness raising and fund raising activities of the Aisling Centre.

"I found it very comfortable and it was painful at times but it helped me to open up and say things that I have never spoke about before"

Meet the Team

Aisling centre
Hope Healing Growth

When you need someone to talk to...
We are here to listen



Give Hope

Give 50p a Day

For 50p a day - less than the price of a pint of milk or a bar of chocolate - you can make a huge difference and help us to provide much needed services in a community where there is an ever growing need.

Your local Counselling, Psychotherapy and Well-Being Service

www.theaislingcentre.com

Help us to help others

Resources available do not meet demand for services.

In the last year Aisling Centre provided an average of 100 sessions of counselling per week.

We need your help to sustain this much needed service.

Give Hope

Give 50p a Day



In difficult times and faced with so many important causes, it can be hard to decide who to support. By choosing to give a regular donation to the Aisling Centre, you can make a huge difference in the life of a person in distress or despair.

Over the year, your 50p per day could provide counselling to help save a life.

How will we use your gift?

We will make your 50p count. Every penny you donate will be used to support service provision.

Can't make a regular gift?

Other ways to help us offer this much needed local service e.g.:-

- a one off donation
- donate in celebration e.g. in lieu of birthday gifts, wedding favours etc...
- a bequest in your will
- nominate us as your work place charity
- undertake a challenge eg sponsored walk

To give please contact

Aisling Centre
37, Darling Street, Enniskillen
Co Fermanagh, BT74 7DP

Telephone: 028 66 325811
Email: info@theaislingcentre.com

Aisling centre
Hope Healing Growth

www.theaislingcentre.com